

Chapter

President and Vice President

1. During a hung assembly when no party gets the majority, the President appoints the Prime Minister. What power is the President exercising?

- (a) Legislative
- (b) Executive
- (c) Discretionary
- (d) Judicial

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2. With reference to the given picture, answer the following questions:

- (a) Identify the personality given in the picture. Who is he?
- (b) How is he elected?
- (c) What are his functions?



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3. The _____ has the power to summon the Houses of Parliament.

- (a) Speaker
- (b) President
- (c) Vice President
- (d) Chief Justice of India

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4. The President is the head of the State and exercises his / her powers on the advice of the Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers. With reference to this, answer the following questions:

(i) What are the three types of emergencies that can be proclaimed by the President?

(ii) Mention any three legislative powers of the President.

(iii) Give any two reasons to justify the need for indirect election of the President. What is the composition of the Electoral College which elects the President?

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5. Study the picture and answer the questions that follow :



(a) Identify the building in the picture and state where it is located. Whose official residence is it ?

(b) State the qualifications necessary to become the President of India.

(c) Why is it said that the President of India is only a nominal head ?

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Solution

1.

Ans: (c) Discretionary

Explanation:

In the case of a hung assembly, when no political party secures a clear majority, the President appoints the Prime Minister using his **discretionary powers**. This power allows the President to act according to his own judgment to ensure the formation of a stable government.

2.

Ans:

(a) The person in the picture is **Jagdeep Dhankhar**, the **Vice-President of India**.

(b) The Vice-President is elected by an **Electoral College consisting of members of both Houses of Parliament**, through **proportional representation by means of a single transferable vote** and **secret ballot**.

(c) Functions of the Vice-President:

(i) He is the **ex-officio Chairman of the Rajya Sabha**.

(ii) He **acts as the President** when the President is unable to discharge his duties.

(iii) He serves as **Acting President** in case of a vacancy in the office of the President.

(iv) He performs **ceremonial and goodwill functions** as assigned.

3.

Ans: (b) President.

Explanation:

The President of India has the constitutional authority to summon, prorogue and dissolve the Houses of Parliament. This power is exercised under Article 85 of the Indian Constitution, which empowers the President to call sessions of Parliament and ensure its proper functioning.

4.

Ans:

(i) Three types of emergencies that can be proclaimed by the President:

(a) **National Emergency** – Proclaimed under Article 352 in case of war, external aggression or armed rebellion.

(b) **State Emergency (President's Rule)** – Proclaimed under Article 356 when the constitutional machinery in a state fails.

(c) **Financial Emergency** – Proclaimed under Article 360 when the financial stability of the country is threatened.

(ii) Three legislative powers of the President:

(a) **Summoning and Proroguing Parliament** – The President can summon, prorogue the Parliament and dissolve the Lok Sabha.

(b) **Assent to Bills** – A bill passed by Parliament becomes law only after the President gives assent or returns it for reconsideration (except Money Bills).

(c) **Ordinance-making Power** – The President can issue ordinances when Parliament is not in session, which have the force of law.

(iii) Reasons justifying the need for indirect election of the President and composition of the Electoral College:

(a) **Representation of States** – Indirect election ensures representation of both the Union and the States.

(b) **Avoidance of Political Conflict** – It prevents rivalry between the President and the Prime Minister.

Electoral College:

The President is elected by an Electoral College consisting of elected members of both Houses of Parliament and the elected members of the State Legislative Assemblies.

5.

Ans:

(a) The building shown in the picture is **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, located in **New Delhi**. It is the **official residence of the President of India**.

(b) The qualifications required to become the President of India are:

(i) He must be a **citizen of India**.

(ii) He must be **at least 35 years of age**.

(iii) He must be **qualified to be elected as a member of the Lok Sabha**.

(iv) He must **not hold any office of profit** under the Government of India or any State Government.

(c) The President of India is called a **nominal head** because real executive powers are exercised by the **Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers**. The President functions mainly on their advice and performs ceremonial duties.